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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 14

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Reserva de un lugar para bodas

Coordinator: Good morning, Oakwood Manor events team, Sophie speaking. How can I help?

Customer: Hi. I'm hoping to book your venue for my wedding next year.

Coordinator: Congratulations! Let me take a few details. Could I have your name?

Customer: Yes, it's Helen Brightwell.

Coordinator: Before we go through the individual choices, I should explain how I handle a wedding-venue booking. I will confirm your priorities first, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Customer: That approach is exactly what I need for the wedding-venue booking. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Coordinator: Could you spell the surname for me?

Customer: Sure - it's B-R-I-G-H-T-W-E-L-L.

Coordinator: Thank you. And the best number to reach you on?

Customer: For this wedding-venue booking, I am more concerned about reliability than an impressive description. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Coordinator: Of course. In this wedding-venue booking, I will make each trade-off explicit as we proceed, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Customer: My mobile is 078 2245 3390.

Coordinator: Lovely. And do you have a date in mind?

Customer: We were set on a Saturday. We originally wanted May, but in the end we've chosen June.

Coordinator: A wedding-venue booking can involve names, dates and choices that sound alike when they are given quickly. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Customer: I will. For the wedding-venue booking, it is useful to know which details are certain, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Coordinator: June is very popular, so it's good you're booking early. How many guests are you expecting?

Customer: Around 140.

Coordinator: That's fine - our main hall holds up to two hundred. Now, which part of the manor would you like for the ceremony itself?

Coordinator: Let me finish the wedding-venue booking by summarising what I have recorded. For this wedding-venue booking, I will read back the information in order, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the wedding-venue booking, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Customer: Good. During the wedding-venue booking, I will listen carefully and check it against the notes I brought.

Customer: I think the garden, as long as the weather's kind.

Coordinator: A garden ceremony is beautiful, and we provide a marquee as a backup. Is there anything special you'd like for the meal?

Customer: One thing that really matters is that we'll need a vegetarian option for a lot of our guests.

Customer: Before we close the wedding-venue booking, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Coordinator: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Coordinator: No problem at all - our chef offers several. And will you need accommodation?

Customer: Mainly for the couple, so just the bridal suite for the first night.

Coordinator: I'll pencil that in. Now let me run through our two packages. The Classic package is £75 per guest and includes a three-course meal and all the table decorations. The Deluxe package is £95 per guest; on top of the meal, it also includes a professional photographer and an evening buffet.

Coordinator: Before I close this wedding-venue booking, I will separate the details we have confirmed from the points that remain optional. Please listen to the complete summary before responding, because correcting one item can sometimes affect a later choice as well. I will keep the original order so that it is easy to compare with your notes.

Customer: That is helpful. I will check each detail as you read it and ask about anything that does not match what I intended. Once the summary is accurate, I will also note the reference and the method for making a later amendment.

Customer: And what about a deposit?

Coordinator: For either package we ask for £500 to secure the date, with the balance due one month before the wedding.

Customer: That all sounds perfect. Thank you.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Indicaciones para una carrera benéfica

Right, everyone, thank you for coming to this briefing for Saturday's Riverside Charity Fun Run. I'm Tom, the event organiser, and I'll run through the key details so the day goes smoothly. Before describing the individual features of this charity fun-run briefing, it is useful to understand the overall sequence. The information for the charity fun-run briefing follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, beginning with orientation and moving towards more specialised areas. Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the charity fun-run briefing easier to follow. First, what you'll receive. Every participant who registers will be given a bright orange race T-shirt - please do wear it on the day, as it helps our marshals identify runners.

Everyone who crosses the finish line will also receive a finisher's medal. Now, a few things that are not automatically provided: the route map is on our website for you to download, energy bars will only be handed out to those doing the longer ten-kilometre route, and a timing chip is issued only to runners in the competitive race, not the fun run. Some arrangements connected with the charity fun-run briefing may operate differently during the present programme. During the charity fun-run briefing, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time. Where a condition in the charity fun-run briefing is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. Now, the practical details.

The run starts at nine thirty in the morning, so please arrive in good time to collect your number. The starting point is the main gate of Victoria Park - not the car park, as some older leaflets wrongly stated. The route follows the river for most of the way and is completely flat, which makes it ideal for beginners. There is one water station, roughly halfway round, where you can also leave any spare clothing. As the charity fun-run briefing continues, a shorter route may reach the same principal areas. Within the charity fun-run briefing, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme. If an alternative becomes necessary during the charity fun-run briefing, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available. Do not try to memorise every detail of the charity fun-run briefing at once. The most important instructions will return when they become relevant. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. A word on safety. The whole route is clearly marked with yellow arrows, and first-aid volunteers are stationed every kilometre. If you feel unwell, stop and wait for a marshal - please don't try to carry on. Dogs, unfortunately, are not allowed this year, for insurance reasons. A final way to follow the charity fun-run briefing is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action.

Descriptions help you build a mental map, whereas instructions tell you when to move or decide. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. On fundraising: all the money we raise this year will go towards a new children's playground in the town. The easiest way to collect donations is through your online sponsorship page. And finally, parking. The park's own car park will be closed for the event, so please use the free parking at the nearby shopping centre and walk across. Thanks again, and let's hope for some sunshine. If you become uncertain during the charity fun-run briefing, pause at the next staffed point

rather than following another group without checking.

Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence. This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Plan de trabajo de campo de geología

Tutor: So, let's finalise the plan for next month's geology fieldwork. Ben, remind us where we're going.

Ben: We're heading to the coast at Kilve, where the cliffs have exposed clear layers of sedimentary rock.

Tutor: Before we settle on an interpretation for the geology fieldwork, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Ben: Agreed. For the geology fieldwork, we can state the initial expectation and then test it against each observation. That will make the argument more credible.

Tutor: Good. And what's the main aim of the trip, Priya?

Priya: Originally we said collecting fossils, but actually our main goal is to measure and record the different rock layers - the sequence, basically.

Ben: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the geology fieldwork. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Tutor: Yes. The audience needs to know what the design can and cannot establish.

Tutor: Exactly - recording the sequence is the priority. Now, how are we getting there?

Ben: We looked at taking the train, but in the end the department minibus works out cheaper for the whole group.

Tutor: Another question is whether our categories for the geology fieldwork are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Ben: For the geology fieldwork, let us define the variable before presenting the measurement. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Tutor: Sensible. It also means we can carry all the equipment. Speaking of which, Priya, what's the situation there?

Priya: Most of it's ready, but we're short of hand lenses - there are only four for twelve students, so people will have to share.

Ben: The order of the geology fieldwork presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Tutor: For the geology fieldwork, we can add a linking sentence at each handover and rehearse the transitions.

Tutor: I'll ask the store to lend us a few more. Now, safety. This is a coastal site, so what's the main risk?

Tutor: Our final review of the geology fieldwork should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Ben: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can record the remaining action beside the person responsible for it.

Ben: The tide, definitely. If we're not careful we could get cut off, so we must check the tide times before we go down onto the beach.

Tutor: Absolutely - the tide is our number-one hazard. Right, a few things for everyone to prepare. First, each of you must bring sturdy boots, because the rocks are very slippery. Second, don't forget a waterproof, as the weather there changes fast. Third, everyone needs to complete the risk form and hand it in to me by Friday. I'll bring the first-aid kit and a spare hammer. Oh, and please label every rock sample you collect with its exact location - an unlabelled sample is useless for the report.

Ben: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the geology fieldwork, including the reason for it.

Tutor: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

Priya: Should we bring cameras as well?

Tutor: Your phones are fine for photographs - just make sure they're fully charged.

Tutor: Before we finish the geology fieldwork, let us read the argument from the perspective of somebody who did not collect the evidence. Each claim should identify what was observed, how it was measured and which limitation affects the interpretation.

Ben: I will also check that our recommendation follows from the result rather than from what we expected at the beginning. If a sentence sounds stronger than the method allows, we can narrow it without losing the main point.

Tutor: Good. Then the final version will show a clear line from the research question through the evidence to the conclusion.

Ben: Great, thanks.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: La historia del papel moneda

Good afternoon. In today's lecture I'll trace the history of paper money, from its origins in China right through to the plastic notes of the present day. To place the paper-money lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it. Within the paper-money lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through repeated experiments, local adaptations and occasional failures. A simple list of events in the paper-money lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. The story begins in China, more than a thousand years ago.

Chinese merchants grew tired of carrying heavy strings of copper coins, so during the Tang dynasty they began leaving their coins with trusted agents, who issued them a paper receipt in exchange. This early paper money was nicknamed "flying money", because a strong wind could easily blow it out of your hands. Evidence for the paper-money lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare individual cases with broader samples collected over time. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. By the following dynasty, the government itself had taken over the printing of the notes, and paper money became official currency. The idea took a very long time to reach Europe. When the traveller Marco Polo returned home and described it, many readers simply did not believe him. Scale is especially important when evaluating the paper-money lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this paper-money lecture, no striking individual example should be treated as a universal rule. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful. Europe's first proper banknotes were issued in Sweden in the seventeenth century. Unfortunately, the bank printed far too many, and the notes quickly lost their value - an early lesson in the danger of inflation.

For the next two centuries, most banknotes were backed by gold: in theory, a note could always be exchanged at the bank for a fixed weight of the metal. It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the paper-money lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. A conclusion should be as strong as the evidence allows, but no stronger. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together. That link to gold was finally broken in the twentieth century. Since then, paper money has been what economists call "fiat" currency, meaning that its value rests entirely on public trust rather than on any precious metal.

The separate examples in the paper-money lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the paper-money lecture, returning to those questions will connect evidence gathered at different scales. The conclusion to the paper-money lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence. Producing notes that are hard to copy has always been a challenge. Modern notes use a range of security features, such as a watermark, a metallic thread running through the paper, and ink that changes colour when the note

is tilted. A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the paper-money lecture less convincing.

Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together. Most recently, several countries have replaced paper with a thin, flexible plastic, usually a material called polymer. These notes last far longer, survive being washed, and are much harder to forge. Some economists predict that, as digital payments spread, physical cash may one day disappear altogether - but for now, the banknote in your pocket remains a remarkable piece of technology. One final point about the paper-money lecture concerns the difference between a useful model and a complete explanation.

A model selects the relationships that matter most for a particular question, so it can be informative even when it leaves out local variation. Problems arise when that simplification is forgotten and a result from one scale is treated as a rule for every case. The evidence discussed here should therefore be read with its conditions attached: the period observed, the population or material studied, the method used and the uncertainty that remains. Those conditions do not weaken the account; they show exactly where the conclusion is supported and where further observation would be needed.